

Baptism: A Google Gemini Analysis

The file "[Baptism.docx](#)" found in / [Topical Bible Studies \(KJV\)](#) / [Topics \(R.A. Torrey, DMC\)](#) / [B](#) / was attached in Google Gemini, along with the additional instructions provided below.

Instructions: "Please write an article about Baptism. Include all the verses on Baptism found in the document."

Note: I did not stack the deck or ask Gemini to favor my view; rather, I gave it very simple instructions. This is to show that a straightforward reading of *all the verses* in the New Testament, *without any interpretations from institutional churches or apologetic responses such as we find on GotQuestions.org*, leads to the conclusion that baptism is essential for salvation.

The Response by Google Gemini

The Significance of Baptism: A Biblical Perspective.

The document "Baptism.docx" explores the practice of baptism based on various scripture verses. It presents baptism as a commandment from Jesus Christ and an essential step for believers.

Baptism as a Commandment and Its Connection to Salvation.

Baptism is directly linked to salvation in scripture. Mark 16:16 states, "**He that believeth and is baptized shall be saved**". The document clarifies that this is not salvation by works, but an act of obedience stemming from love for Jesus Christ. Jesus commanded His followers, "**Go ye therefore, and Teach all nations, baptizing them in the name of the Father, and of the Son, and of the Holy Ghost**". Peter also commanded believers to "be baptized in the name of the Lord".

Prerequisites for Baptism: Repentance and Faith.

Before being baptized, repentance of sins and belief in Jesus Christ are presented as necessary prerequisites. Acts 2:38 instructs, "Repent, and be baptized every one of you in the name of Jesus Christ for the remission of sins, and ye shall receive the gift of the Holy Ghost". The

Ethiopian eunuch, when asking to be baptized, was told by Philip, "If thou believest with all thine heart, thou mayest". The eunuch responded, "I believe that Jesus Christ is the Son of God". Matthew 3:6 mentions people being "baptized of him in Jordan, confessing their sins".

The Mode of Baptism: Immersion in Much Water.

The document indicates that baptism involves immersion in "much water". John was "baptizing in AEnon near to Salim, because there was much water there". The account of Philip and the eunuch describes them going "down both into the water" and coming "up out of the water".

Baptism in the Name of the Father, Son, and Holy Ghost,

Or in the Name of Jesus Christ?

Baptism is to be performed "**in the name of the Father, and of the Son, and of the Holy Ghost**".

The document also notes instances of baptism being done "in the name of the Lord Jesus".

The Purpose and Symbolism of Baptism.

Baptism is for the remission of sins and the reception of the Holy Ghost. Acts 22:16 says, "arise, and be baptized, and wash away thy sins, calling on the name of the Lord". Ephesians 5:26 refers to the church being sanctified and cleansed "with the washing of water by the word".

Baptism also symbolizes the believer's union with Christ's death, burial, and resurrection.

Romans 6:3-4 asks, "Know ye not, that so many of us as were baptized into Jesus Christ were baptized into his death? Therefore we are buried with him by baptism into death: that like as Christ was raised up from the dead by the glory of the Father, even so we also should walk in newness of life". Colossians 2:12 states, "Buried with him in baptism, wherein also ye are risen with him through the faith of the operation of God, who hath raised him from the dead".

Furthermore, baptism unites believers with Christ's body, the church. 1 Corinthians 12:13 explains, "For by one Spirit are we all baptized into one body, whether we be Jews or Gentiles, whether we be bond or free; and have been all made to drink into one Spirit". Galatians 3:27-28 adds, "For as many of you as have been baptized into Christ have put on Christ. There is neither Jew nor Greek, there is neither bond nor free, there is neither male nor female: for ye are all one in Christ Jesus".

Baptism is also presented as replacing circumcision as the seal of the New Covenant. Colossians

2:11-13 speaks of being "circumcised with the circumcision made without hands, in putting off the body of the sins of the flesh by the circumcision of Christ: Buried with him in baptism... And you, being dead in your sins... hath he quickened together with him, having forgiven you all trespasses".

One Baptism, But Rebaptism When Necessary.

Ephesians 4:5 mentions "One Lord, one Faith, one baptism". However, the document notes that rebaptism is necessary when the gospel was not understood during the first baptism, as seen in Acts 19:3-5.

Examples and Exceptions.

The document discusses John's baptism of repentance and highlights Christ's example of being baptized by John. It also mentions instances of entire households being baptized.

The case of the thief on the cross is presented as an exception, demonstrating that faith in Jesus Christ can save in rare circumstances when baptism is impossible. However, the document cautions against using this as an excuse to avoid baptism when able.

The example of Simon Magus (Acts 8:12-25) illustrates that belief and baptism are not sufficient without genuine repentance. Although Simon believed and was baptized, he had not repented and therefore had not received the Holy Ghost; his heart was "not right in the sight of God".

The document concludes by stating that baptism "saves" in a similar way that Noah's ark "saved" from the flood (1 Peter 3:20-21), as a symbol and act of obedience. Ultimately, salvation comes through faith in Jesus Christ, and baptism is a sign that unites the repentant believer in Christ's death. Upon baptism, the believer receives the Holy Ghost and is sealed unto the day of redemption. The refusal of baptism when possible is considered unbelief and a denial of Christ, with no forgiveness of sins in such a case.